

introduction

2024/12/09

1. Template package usage and functions

About ten years ago, I liked to use markdown to write documents, just because Microsoft Office or WPS was too cumbersome. Later, I gradually found that using Office Word or WPS was a bit of an overkill for small-scale documents such as daily technical documents and group work plans. The commonly used formats are nothing more than titles, lists, tables, and text paragraphs. There is no need to use an old computer to run a huge document editor application. I have a certain programming foundation and I know that separating text content from format can be more conducive to focusing on writing.

However, after writing content in markdown, when distributing it, I have always encountered such difficulties. Using pandoc to convert to pdf requires installing a huge latex engine. Using pandoc to convert markdown files to docx, then opening them in wps or Microsoft Office and exporting them to pdf is cumbersome and does not meet the requirements of the simplicity of document writing workflow.

Until 2024, I meet **typst**, which has been open source for some time. It is very familiar to me. It only needs to install typst of dozens of MB to convert the markdown file of the document content into pdf. It only takes seconds to produce very high-quality pdf documents or png images. I am very grateful for the contribution of the typst team.

I simplified the original workflow of `markdown to docx to pdf` based on `pandoc` to `markdown to pdf or png` with the support of pandoc and **typst**. Of course, it took more than two months to learn typst programming syntax and compile this document template program.

The original intention of designing this document template is to meet the document writing requirements of my daily work. This template is very **Opinioned**. The main types of these documents are:

- Technical solution description
- Work plan
- Summary

- Log

Book publishing and academic papers are not considered for the time being. This template lacks support for document formats that have high requirements for these layouts.

2. 模板包示例

分发包中包含的所有 pdf 文档，均由本文档模板程序定义的 [typst 规则][Typst 规则]生成，`examples` 目录下的示例，是由模板程序所生成 **用户手册**，分别有多种不同的颜色主题。示例效果见 《userguide》 中的 **支持的样式**。

3. Examples

All pdf documents included in the released package are generated by the typst rules defined by this document template program. The examples in the `examples` directory are **User Manual** generated by this template program , each with a different color theme. For demonstration, see **Supported styles** in "userguide" pdf.

4. Contents of the template package

```
|—— CHANGELOG.pdf
|—— LICENSE
|—— examples
|—— howto.pandoc.pdf
|—— howto.themekit.pdf
|—— pandoc
|—— pandoc.vs.themekit.pdf
|—— themekit
|—— userguide.dark.ayu-dark.pdf
|—— userguide.light.ayu-dark.pdf
|—— version.txt
└—— readmefirst.pdf
```

- `readmefirst.pdf` , this document.
- `pandoc` directory, you can directly use the typst template referenced by pandoc, early development version, see `howto.pandoc.pdf` for usage.
- `themekit` directory, padoc typst template organized in the form of typst local package, consistent with the typst rules in the `pandoc` directory, simplifying the commands when using. See `howto.themekit.pdf` for usage.

- `examples` directory, sample pdf generated using this document template, these sample documents are actually the "User Manual" of this template program. Each file demonstrates a different color style.
- `pandoc.vs.themekit.pdf`, functional differences and focuses between the pandoc directory and the themekit directory.
- `howto*.pdf`: simplified instructions for using the template, the details of the template library are described in detail in `userguide*.pdf`.
- `userguide*.pdf`: User manual of this document template library, including template program structure description, effect examples, issues to be aware of, etc.
- `CHANGELOG.pdf`, change log description of the release package, including new and modified functions, as well as fixed issues.
- `LICENSE`, license requirements implemented by this document template program
- `version.txt`: The version corresponding to the document template program will change with the release version.

5. how to use

Before using this template to convert markdown to pdf, it is recommended to read the following chapters in the "userguide":

1. Template description
2. Limitations
3. Demonstration

This document template program is organized in two different forms, that is, there are two different usage methods and their more suitable usage scenarios. The differences between them can be found in the description of "`pandoc.vs.themekit.pdf`". For specific operations, see "`howto.pandoc.pdf`" and "`howto.themekit.pdf`". No matter which one is used, the generated PDF document effect is the same. This template program ensures that the rules in the two `pandoc` directories and the `themekit` directory are consistent.